

Kumari Shipra
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Impact-Driven **Strategic Project & Agile Leader** with **9 years** of **cross-functional** experience driving AI-led Digital Transformation, Automation & Platform Innovation for **Fortune 500 & Consulting firms** across **Financial Services, FinTech & Banking**. Proven ability to lead **high-impact Projects, cost savings**, and accelerate **Time-To-Market (TTM) by 80%** with strong expertise in **GenAI, Project Strategy, Roadmap Development, Go-To-Market (GTM) Execution, Agile (Scrum, Kanban)** and **Stakeholder Leadership**. Passionate about building **scalable, data-driven & user-centric Projects** that fuel **exponential business impact**. Recognized for exceptional ability to lead cross-functional teams, fostering a collaborative and innovative environment that drives project success and accountability.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Project Manager

PWC

Oct'24 – Feb'25

Demonstrated strong leadership skills by successfully guiding diverse teams at Adobe and Microsoft. Throughout my tenure, I've overseen the entire project lifecycle, from formulating business cases to project initiation, planning, and execution. My commitment to ongoing enhancement prompted me to closely monitor essential metrics such as KPIs, compliance, and risk factors. I prioritized transparent communication by consistently providing stakeholders with weekly updates on project progress and developments.

- Monitoring and reporting on project progress, identifying potential challenges, and proactively implementing solutions to keep projects on track and aligned with business goals.
- Overseeing **multiple programs**, aligning them with corporate strategy through project goal setting and **charter development**.
- Coordinating the project portfolio to support strategic aims by defining project parameters and deliverables.
- Leading cross-functional projects across multiple business verticals, driving initiatives, and ensuring alignment with corporate objectives.
- **Managing end-to-end project lifecycles, from planning and resource allocation to execution and post-implementation reviews**, ensuring timely delivery and achievement of key milestones.
- Developing and implementing **project management frameworks** and best practices to optimize efficiency, mitigate risks, and enhance overall program performance.
- Facilitating seamless communication and coordination between various departments, fostering collaboration, and driving successful project outcomes
- Leading automation initiatives and **supervising full-cycle delivery of technical solutions via timeline planning**, resource coordination, budget oversight, and milestone monitoring.
- Tracking and addressing project challenges using risk documentation, escalating urgent impediments to ensure on-schedule delivery.
- Managing project uncertainties and issues via structured risk tools, promptly informing stakeholders of critical concerns for timely completion.

Manager

Dec '20 - Jun'24

HSBC

1. **End-to-End Discovery & Transition Ownership:** Led the discovery and transition phases, aligning cross-functional teams across ASP Canada and MENAT Regions, ensuring documentation, process clarity, and operational readiness.
2. **Operational Optimization:** Identified inefficiencies, designed mitigation strategies, and oversaw smooth transition into production-ready processes.
3. **Stakeholder Engagement:** Facilitated collaboration and alignment, validated workflows, and ensured adoption readiness.
4. **Process and Resource Planning:** Allocate resources effectively for multistream bank programs, optimize effort estimation for regulatory & IT projects
5. **Continuous Improvement:** Post transition oversight to drive process excellence, monitor KPIs, and implement feedback loops for operational efficiency

6. Ensure adherence to regulatory standards and internal controls for audit readiness .

- Led daily stand-ups, sprint reviews, and retrospective meetings, actively pinpointing and resolving challenges.
- Upgraded Developer Productivity with **80% faster Bug Resolutions** by introducing a **Log Monitoring Framework** that enables real-time system performance tracking
- Created **Leadership Reports & Dashboards** to monitor **Project Portfolios**, enabling Data-Driven Decision Making & aligning Organizational Strategy.
- Organized **Scrum ceremonies**, reviewed **High Level System Design (HLD)**, conducted code reviews, and tracked project status to ensure alignment with business goals and timely delivery.
- **Mentored & coached 13 junior team members** through **on-job training, personal development, and performance management**, while actively participating in **recruitment efforts** to build a strong **Agile team**, fostering a **high-performance culture**.
- Closely worked with Top business stakeholders to migrate the regulatory report and BAU Reports
- Conducted regular retrospective to gain insights and worked on data migration for different markets (ASP, MENAT, UK and Europe)

Assistant Manager

HSBC

Aug '17 - Dec '20

- Prepared governance reports and materials including steering committee packs , dashboards , governance materials and monthly reports in forums .
- Authored **PRDs, BRDs, and stakeholder pitch presentations** to align Project vision, secure buy-in, and drive execution for multiple client projects.
- Optimized **backlog management** and sprint execution by **facilitating Scrum ceremonies, refining KPIs, and aligning OKRs**, ensuring faster Project iterations and **data-driven decision-making**.
- Facilitated development of **Generative AI Agent (Chatbot) 'DUGBot'** for Export Controls that accurately **detected 99.6%** of **High-Risk transactions** in Trade Finance through **Prompt Engineering** techniques, enhancing **AML / CTF** controls and strengthening HSBC's Regulatory Compliance. • Applied **Agile Methodology** in building a strategic Roadmap for 'DUGBot', optimizing **Project Backlog Refinements** & managing User

Stories resulting in **15%** faster sprint completions.

- Orchestrated agile sprints to consolidate million data points from diverse structured and unstructured client systems, leveraging SQL to generate actionable business insights.
- Lead end to end delivery of compliance and regulatory initiatives across **KYC, Customer Onboarding , CDD and EDD programs** .
- Directed the creation of a Tableau dashboard for real-time process monitoring and quality assurance, enabling proactive decision making and operational efficiency.

Associate

May '15 - Jul '17

WIPRO

- Drove **digital transformation** for USA-based External Client & UK-based External Client by leading cross-functional teams in data-driven decision making, backlog prioritization, and Agile execution, ensuring seamless project delivery.
- Optimized **sprint execution** by strategic **JIRA Backlog Management** for a team of **5 Data Engineers**, reducing **Project backlogs by 85% weekly** and enhancing development efficiency.
- Revamped **due diligence operations by 90%** by designing system architectures (HLD & LLD)
- Built an **NLP-powered Pattern Matching Algorithm** to **classify Banking Merchant payments** and enhance **Anti-Money Laundering (AML) Models**, strengthening **fraud detection** capabilities.
- Gained **60% operational efficiency** by automating **Account Receivable (A/R) Reconciliations** for USA-based External Client
- Spearheaded **recruitment efforts** by **interviewing & assessing candidates** for Python, SQL & Data Structures, strengthening **Data Analytics team**.

EDUCATION

B.Tech - Computer Science Engineering May '15 JNTU, Kakinada Vizag, India

KEY SKILLS

- **Data-Driven Decision Making** – Thought Leadership, Data Analytics, KPI & OKR Definition, Business Intelligence (BI), Financial Insights, Risk & Compliance Analytics.
- **Process Automation & Optimization** – Digital Transformation, Workflow Automation, Process Re-Engineering, Cost Reduction Strategies,
- **User Experience (UX) & Design Thinking Principles** – Wireframing, Rapid Prototyping, Customer Journey Mapping, UX Research, A/B Testing
- **Stakeholder Management & Cross-Functional Leadership** – C-Level Communication, Executive Reporting, Team Mentorship, Vendor Management
- **Project & Program Management** – Project Roadmaps, Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy, Agile Project Development, MVP & Feature Prioritization, User Research, Competitive Analysis, Business Model Innovation, Market Research, Project Life Cycle Management.
- **Agile & IT Project Management** – Agile Methodologies (Scrum, Kanban), Backlog Management, Sprint Planning, User Story Mapping, Jira, Confluence, Stakeholder Collaboration, User Acceptance Criteria, User Stories, Strategic Program Management, Requirements Gathering.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Project & Agile Tools** – JIRA, Confluence, ServiceNow, Microsoft Office 365 (Excel, PowerPoint, Visio, Planner), ChatGPT
- **Data & Analytics** – SQL (MySQL, SQL Server), Advance MS Excel, Excel automation using VBA

CERTIFICATIONS

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- DATA SCIENCE & ANALYTICS CERTIFICATION PROGRAM (IVY Professional School)